

Marketing wanted Aggressive Targeting. Risk
Wanted a Veto. ML Had No Mandate. —
Navigating Four Competing Agendas to Ship a
Regulated NBA Platform

- XFN NAVIGATION
- COMPETING AGENDAS
- INFLUENCE W/O AUTHORITY
- PROACTIVE ALIGNMENT
- FCA REGULATED

SITUATION — FOUR COMPETING AGENDAS (CHANG CH.7 PILLAR 3)

I was leading delivery of the NBA ML platform with no formal authority over any of the four teams whose cooperation I needed. Marketing wanted to maximise contact volume and remove channel caps — revenue pressure. Risk & Compliance wanted model-level veto power and a 4-week MRM gate on every change. PEGA Admins owned the decisioning engine and resisted the API integration contract I proposed, preferring to own the score logic themselves. Data Science BL leads each wanted their model to take precedence in PEGA arbitration.

TASK — THE COMPLEXITY (NOT A MIGRATION. NOT REPORTING.)

Align four teams with **directly opposing objectives** around a shared governance model — while simultaneously designing the ML architecture, satisfying FCA TCF requirements, and delivering a pilot A/B test that Marketing, Risk, and the CTO would each accept as legitimate evidence. If I built the A/B platform without proactively aligning Marketing, the results would have been **rejected as biased** and the friction would have killed the rollout.

ACTION — PROACTIVE ALIGNMENT BEFORE BUILDING ANYTHING

1. Stakeholder mapping first: Before writing a line of code, I mapped each team's primary objective, their veto risk, and their minimum acceptable outcome — then designed the governance model around their constraints, not mine. 2. Marketing

STAKEHOLDER NAVIGATION MAP (CHANG CH.7 — PILLAR 3)

WHO WANTED WHAT — AND HOW I MOVED EACH		
Stakeholder	Wanted / Feared	Outcome
Marketing (CRM)	Max contact volume; no channel caps	Co-owner ✓
Risk & Compliance	Full MRM veto on every model change	Tiered gate ✓
PEGA Admins	Own the score logic; resist API	Built next API ✓
DS BL Leads (×4)	Their model to win arbitration	Neutral charter ✓
CTO / CCO	Delivery; no regulatory incident	Co-presented ✓

- ⚡ FRICTION POINTS NAVIGATED — GENUINE COMPLEXITY**
- 1

Marketing vs ML: Marketing initially refused to allow a 20% holdout — "we lose revenue on the control group." Resolution: I showed the cost of shipping a model the business doesn't trust — the previous 14-month stall. They accepted the holdout as insurance.
- 2

Risk 4-week gate: Blocking iteration entirely. Resolution: tiered MRM — minor vs material changes. Required 3 rounds of negotiation with

XFN PRINCIPLES APPLIED (CHANG CH.7 — PILLAR 3)

INFLUENCE WITHOUT AUTHORITY — HOW

Built their goals into your design. Marketing's opt-out SLO became a guardrail in the A/B test they co-owned. Risk's review gate became a formal tiered standard. Each stakeholder saw their priority reflected in the output. [Ch.7](#)

Made evidence theirs, not yours. Marketing co-presented the results to the CTO. They moved from blocker to advocate by owning the outcome. [Ch.7](#)

Changed the frame, not the facts. "API integration" became "ML provides signals, PEGA retains all decisions." Same technical design — different political outcome. [Navigation](#)

PROACTIVE VS REACTIVE ALIGNMENT

Before A/B design: Marketing joined the test design meeting — they defined the KPIs and duration. Result: they defended the test's validity when challenged by the CFO. [Proactive](#)

Before architecture: I mapped PEGA's contact cap logic before designing the ML integration — discovered it was undocumented, not in any system of record. Surfaced early, not at launch. [Proactive](#)

Before escalation: Wealth BL refusal was escalated with two defined options — not as a problem, but as a decision for the CTO with trade-offs quantified. [Navigation](#)

4 Teams Aligned

0

+22% Conversion Lift

Bank MRM Standard

Escalations Post-Launch

INTERVIEWER SIGNAL — XFN COMPLEXITY & COMMUNICATION

This is not a reporting project or a migration. It is four teams with opposing regulatory, commercial, and political incentives, navigated without authority. Each answer stays on the specific XFN challenge

Innovate UK had NO ML Evidence Standard. DfT Disagreed with Engineering. Atera Engineering Wanted a Different Model. — Three-Body Alignment on a Safety-Critical Platform

SITUATION — THREE EXTERNAL BODIES, OPPOSING STANDARDS

I was the ML lead on CAM Pathfinder One with no authority over Innovate UK, DfT, or Atera's engineering team — all three of whose cooperation was required for delivery. Innovate UK (grant body) had published WP deliverables in vague English — each work package owner interpreted them differently. DfT technical reviewers wanted a safety case standard that conflicted with what Innovate UK had told us to produce. Atera's internal engineering team had proposed a single neural network end-to-end — directly contradicting the decomposed three-model architecture I believed was necessary for regulatory explainability.

TASK — THE COMPLEXITY (THREE CONFLICTING AUTHORITIES, ONE DEADLINE)

Align Innovate UK, DfT, and internal engineering around a **single ML safety case** that satisfied the AV Act 2024, was evidenced by WP6 deliverables, and was technically defensible — while the three parties had **never been in the same room** and operated on different timelines. Failure to align DfT before the WP5 safety case submission would have triggered a grant audit. Failure to align engineering would have shipped a model I could not defend under AV Act scrutiny.

ACTION — PROACTIVE THREE-WAY ALIGNMENT BEFORE ANY CODE

1. Convened a joint scoping session with Innovate UK programme manager and DfT technical monitor in week 2 — before any

STAKEHOLDER NAVIGATION MAP (CHANG CH.7 — PILLAR 3)

WHO WANTED WHAT — AND HOW I MOVED EACH		
Stakeholder	Wanted / Feared	Outcome
Innovate UK (PM)	WP evidence on their timeline; vague spec	Co-spec agreed ✓
DfT (Tech Monitor)	AV Act safety case; different from IUK spec	SHAP template ✓
Atera Engineering	End-to-end NN; resist decomposition	Research branch ✓
Atera CTO	Grant compliance; ODD expansion	2 ODDs approved ✓
Safety Expert (WP5)	CRITICAL data — impossible to collect safely	Isaac Sim ✓

- ⚡ FRICTION POINTS NAVIGATED — GENUINE TRICKY SITUATIONS**
- 1 IUK vs DfT standards conflict: Two external authorities with opposing interpretations — neither would formally defer to the other. Resolution: convened them jointly in week 2; presented the conflict as a decision they needed to make together. First time either body had been asked to reconcile directly on an Innovate UK AV project.
 - 2 Engineering NN preference: Senior engineer believed decomposition was over-engineering. Resolution: 2-week model comparison on held-out data. Their preferred model produced no auditable SHAP rationale — WP5 would have failed. Evidence, not hierarchy, resolved it.

XFN PRINCIPLES APPLIED (CHANG CH.7 — PILLAR 3)

- 📌 INFLUENCE WITHOUT AUTHORITY — HOW**
- Named the conflict early and directly. "You have told us different things — we need one agreed specification before we build." This is uncomfortable to say to two external grant bodies. It is far less uncomfortable than a WP5 audit failure. [Ch.7](#)
- Translated abstract disagreement into a concrete decision. One-page comparison of the two standards with regulatory risk of each — gave IUK and DfT a choice, not a debate. [Navigation](#)
- Gave the losing party a face-saving win. Engineering's NN became a research branch — their work wasn't wasted, their relationship wasn't damaged. [Ch.7](#)
- ✅ PROACTIVE VS REACTIVE ALIGNMENT**
- Week 2 joint session: Convened IUK + DfT before any architecture was committed. Standard conflict surfaced and resolved before it became a submission blocker. [Proactive](#)
- WP3 before WP4: Isaac Sim approach for CRITICAL synthetic data aligned with safety expert at physics modelling stage — not discovered as a gap at model validation. [Proactive](#)
- Week 3 data audit: OSM quality gap surfaced and imputation strategy agreed before feature engineering began — not as a last-minute patch at WP6 submission. [Proactive](#)

3
Bodies
Aligned

8 WPs

0
Grant
Flags

2
ODDs
Expansion
Approved

On Schedule

🔍 INTERVIEWER SIGNAL — XFN COMPLEXITY & NAVIGATION

Three external authorities with conflicting mandates, navigated without formal authority over any of them. Friction was surfaced and resolved before it became a delivery blocker — not reported